
BABY BANKROLLING

1. **Pump for free.** You can get a free breast pump through Obamacare. And at least one appointment with a lactation consultant must be covered. Get it while it lasts.
 2. **Bunk up with your baby.** The baby should sleep in your room for at least the first six months, maybe the first year, so you don't need to spend money on a baby's room (or move into a home with another bedroom) before the baby needs it.
 3. **Avoid buying baby clothes.** "I have bought my baby I think two items of clothing her entire life, and the rest have been things that other people have either given us as gifts and a lot of hand-me-downs," Sale said.
 4. **Plan ahead.** What's your plan for child care and babysitting? What's your plan for eventual school? Will you save for her college or other future plans? Sale said she is "paying an arm and a leg for child care" currently and is having a hard time thinking about the kid's future beyond the next few months. But it's something you *have* to do.
 5. **Check your company's parental leave policies.** If you have an employee handbook or website, you can look up the leave policy ideally before you get pregnant. Some companies will pay some or all of your salary for a set number of weeks; others simply guarantee you your job when you return. Determine whether you'll be able to get by with the level of income your company will provide (if any) for the duration of your leave.
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